8 Projects (optional, for fun) FULL

n8n 1. Install n8n and send yourself an email

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- n8n (say "n-eight-n") in Docker, connected to your own Gmail, and a first workflow that emails you when you click a button.
- Easy, 45 minutes, free. Do guide 02 (Docker) first.
- Start it: `docker compose -f docker/extras/n8n.yml up -d`, then open http://localhost:5678 and make an owner account with a **new** password.
- Already switched n8n on in the menu (menu `9`, Parts)? Then it is running (and in your backups): skip the start command. Use one way or the other, not both: both run as `garden-n8n`.
- Make a Gmail app password (2-Step Verification must be on). Google shows it only once.
- In n8n, make an SMTP credential: host `smtp.gmail.com`, port `465`, SSL/TLS on.
- Make a workflow: **Trigger manually**, then **Send Email**. Click **Execute workflow** and check your inbox (and spam).
- Never paste the app password into a chat, a document or a screenshot. If it leaks, delete it in your Google account and make a new one.

Level: easy. **Time:** 45 minutes. **Cost:** free.

What you will build

n8n (say "n-eight-n") in Docker, connected to your own Gmail address (**you@gmail.com**), and a first workflow that sends you an email when you click a button.

A **workflow** is a set of boxes ("nodes") joined by arrows. The first box says *when* to start. The next boxes say *what to do*. Nothing needs code.

What you need first

- Guide 02 (Docker) done.
- Access to your own Google account (your Gmail). Only you do this part. Nobody else needs your Google password, and nobody else should have it.

Steps

Part A. Start n8n

1. From the `junsgarden-for-jun` folder:

```
docker compose -f docker/extras/n8n.yml up -d
```

(Or: `bash lab/07-start-extras.sh n8n`.) *You should see:* `Container n8n Started`. The first start downloads about a gigabyte, so wait a few minutes. n8n listens on this laptop only. 2. Open **http://localhost:5678**. *You should see:* a screen asking you to set up an owner account. 3. Make the account. Use your email and a **new** password. Save it in your password manager. (This account is only for n8n. It is not your Google password.)

Part B. Make a Gmail "app password"

Gmail does not let other programs use your real password. Instead you make a separate password that works only for this one purpose, and you can delete it any time. 4. Open your Google account: https://myaccount.google.com and go to **Security**. 5. Turn on **2-Step**

Verification if it is not on. App passwords exist only when it is on. 6. Open https://myaccount.google.com/apppasswords (or search "App passwords" inside Security). Name it `n8n` and click **Create**. 7. Google shows 16 letters **once**. Copy them now and paste them into your password manager with the note "n8n app password". You do not need the spaces.

> **Never paste the app password into a chat, a document or a screenshot.** It goes only into n8n's credential box in the next part. If it leaks, delete it in your Google account and make a new one.

Part C. Tell n8n about your email

8. In n8n click **Credentials** (left side), **Create credential**, search **SMTP**, and choose it. (SMTP is the standard way to send email.)
9. Fill in:

Box	Value
User	`you@gmail.com`
Password	the app password from step 7
Host	`smtp.gmail.com`
Port	`465`
SSL/TLS	**on**

10. Name it `My Gmail (send)` and click **Save**. Click **Test** if shown. *You should see:* "Connection tested successfully".

Part D. Your first workflow

11. Click **Create workflow**. Name it `First email`.
12. Click **Add first step**, choose **Trigger manually** (a button you click).

13. Click the **+** after it, search **Send Email**, and choose it. Set:
    - Credential: `My Gmail (send)`
    - From Email: `you@gmail.com`
    - To Email: `you@gmail.com`
    - Subject: `Hello from my garden lab`
    - Email Format: Text
    - Text: `This email was sent by my own n8n in Docker.`
14. Click **Execute workflow** (bottom). *You should see:* green ticks on both boxes.
15. Open your Gmail. *You should see:* the email. (Check spam if it is not in the inbox.)
16. Click **Save**, then flip the **Inactive/Active** switch at the top right to **Active** later when you have a schedule.

How you know it worked

The email arrived in your inbox, sent by your own computer.

If something goes differently

What you see	What to do
`Invalid login` / `535`	The app password was typed wrong, or 2-Step Verification is off. Make a new app password.
`ETIMEDOUT` or `ECONNREFUSED`	Your network blocks port 465. Try port `587` with SSL/TLS **off** (n8n then upgrades the connection to secure by itself).
Cannot open `localhost:5678`	`docker ps` should list `garden-n8n`. If not: run step 1 again. `docker logs garden-n8n` shows why.
Email went to spam	Mark "Not spam". Sending to yourself from yourself is usually fine after that.

Make it yours

- Change the subject to include the date. Click the **Subject** box, choose **Expression**, and type `Garden check {{ $now.toFormat('yyyy-LL-dd') }}`. The double braces mean "work this out first".
- Add a second recipient.

Next: n8n 2: A dry-soil email

loved.
endured.
never forgotten.